

4.1 Unit description

Introduction

In this unit students will address key aspects of a chosen theme over a period of at least 100 years in order to develop their understanding of the process of change over a long period of time. They will investigate issues relating to the long- and short-term causes and consequences of change and will demonstrate an understanding of the factors that may accelerate, consolidate or delay the process of change.

Students should follow a short introductory taught course that provides an overview of the key strands of development in the chosen topic over a period of at least 100 years. The course should provide the context for students' enquiries.

Students are required to complete a programme in two parts. Each part will be equally weighted within the marks allocated.

- In Part A, students will complete an in-depth enquiry into the short-term significance of a key event, individual, development or movement within the period of study.
- In Part B, students will set their chosen event or individual in a broader context, exploring the process of change within the wider timeframe.

For example, a student following course *CW19: Representation and Democracy in Britain, c.1830-1931* may choose for Part A of the programme to enquire into the significance of the Bristol Riots of 1831 in bringing about reform in 1832. For Part B, they may then choose to explore the role and significance of popular pressure in the process of change in representation and democracy in England over the whole period.

Edexcel-designed coursework programmes for this unit have been designed to ensure that, in combination with Unit 3, students follow a broad and coherent course in which they study either two periods or two countries. Teachers designing their own programmes must design them so these criteria are met.